

Grammar Escape Room 3



Escape Room 3: Grammar Island Survivor

5th Grade | Complex Sentences, Conjunctions, Prepositional Phrases, Verb Tenses

TEKS: 5.11D.vii, 5.11D.ii

Design Overview

- **Color Palette:** Tropical green (#00B894), ocean blue (#0984E3), sandy tan (#FFEAA7), sunset orange (#E17055), palm brown
 - **Font:** Fredoka One (headers), Quicksand (body)
 - **Characters:** Captain Castaway (shipwrecked explorer), Island Animals (parrot, turtle, crab — each guards a challenge)
 - **Interactive Mechanic:** Each challenge builds a piece of the escape raft. Wrong answers → animal helper gives grammar tip.
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SLIDE-BY-SLIDE BREAKDOWN

SLIDE 1 — Title Slide

Visual: Tropical island with palm trees, turquoise water, white sand. A broken raft on the shore. Parrot on a branch. Tiki torches frame the title.

Text: > #  GRAMMAR ISLAND SURVIVOR  > *Build Your Raft. Escape the Island.*
> > Grade 5 | Grammar Escape Room > >  You're stranded! Solve grammar challenges to build your escape raft!

SLIDE 2 — Island Briefing

Visual: Captain Castaway (scruffy explorer with a torn map) standing on the beach. A message in a bottle lies at their feet.

Text: > ## 🗺️ Survivor Briefing > > “You’ve been shipwrecked on Grammar Island! 🌴 Your only hope is to build an **escape raft** — but the island animals guard the supplies! > > Complete **5 grammar challenges** to earn raft pieces: > 🪵 Logs | 🧵 Rope | 🚢 Sail | 🗺️ Map | 🚩 Flag > > Each challenge you solve earns one piece + a **compass coordinate**. Collect all 5 coordinates to chart your escape route! > > **Your Grammar Survival Kit:** > - 📝 Complex Sentences & Conjunctions > - 🔗 Prepositional Phrases > - 🕒 Verb Tenses (including irregular past tense) > > ➡️ *Click the message in a bottle to begin!”*

SLIDE 3 — Raft Tracker

Visual: Top-down view of a raft being built. 5 empty slots for pieces. Compass rose at bottom with 5 coordinate slots. Ocean water around the edges.

Text: > ## 🚢 RAFT TRACKER > > | Piece | Challenge | Earned? | Coordinate | > | --- |
 --- | --- | --- | > | 🪵 Logs | Challenge 1 | ☐ | ____ | > | 🧵 Rope | Challenge 2 |
☐ | ____ | > | 🚢 Sail | Challenge 3 | ☐ | ____ | > | 🗺️ Map | Challenge 4 | ☐ | ____ | > |
 🚩 Flag | Challenge 5 | ☐ | ____ | > > **Escape Route Coordinates: ____ — ____ — ____ —
 ____ — ____ **

CHALLENGE 1: The Log Lagoon (Subordinating Conjunctions)

SLIDE 4 — Challenge 1 Story

Visual: A lagoon with floating logs. A wise old sea turtle blocks the path. Lush greenery surrounds the water.

Text: > ## 🪵 Challenge 1: The Log Lagoon > > Old Shelly the Sea Turtle guards the logs you need! > > 🐢 “I’ll give you the logs, but first you must show me you understand

subordinating conjunctions — the words that connect a dependent clause to an independent clause!” > > 🧠 **Remember:** Subordinating conjunctions include: *because, although, when, while, since, if, before, after, until, unless* > > They create **complex sentences**: “**Although** it was raining, we played outside.”

📌 SLIDE 5 — Challenge 1 Questions

Text: > ## 🧑‍🚀 Challenge 1: Subordinating Conjunctions > > **Choose the correct subordinating conjunction to complete each sentence.** > > **1.** ____ the sun went down, the temperature dropped quickly. > - A) But > - B) After ✅ > - C) And > > **2.** We can’t go swimming ____ the lifeguard arrives. > - A) until ✅ > - B) and > - C) so > > **3.** ____ she studied all night, she still felt nervous about the test. > - A) Because > - B) Although ✅ > - C) When > > **4.** The dog hides under the bed ____ there is thunder. > - A) unless > - B) before > - C) whenever ✅ > > **5.** You should wear a jacket ____ it is cold outside. > - A) but > - B) since ✅ > - C) or

Correct Answers: 1-B, 2-A, 3-B, 4-C, 5-B

📌 SLIDE 5B — Hint

Text: > ## 🦎 Shelly’s Hint: > “A subordinating conjunction connects a **DEPENDENT** clause (can’t stand alone) to an **INDEPENDENT** clause (complete thought). Read the sentence — which word makes **BOTH** parts connect logically? Try each option and see which makes the most sense!”

📌 SLIDE 6 — Challenge 1 Reward

Visual: Turtle pushes logs toward the raft. A coordinate letter glows.

Text: > ## ✅ Logs Earned! 🧑‍🚀 > 🦎 “Well done, survivor! Take the logs and this coordinate!” > > # 🧭 Coordinate: N > 🖋️ Record on your Raft Tracker! ➡️ *On to Challenge 2!*

🧵 CHALLENGE 2: The Rope Bridge (Coordinating Conjunctions & Compound Sentences)

SLIDE 7 — Challenge 2 Story

Visual: A rickety rope bridge over a ravine. A cheeky parrot sits on a post, holding rope in its claws.

Text: > ## 🧵 Challenge 2: The Rope Bridge > > Polly the Parrot has the rope, but she wants to test you first! > > 🦜 “SQUAWK! Coordinating conjunctions! FANBOYS! Show me you can combine sentences properly, and the rope is yours!” > > 🧠 **FANBOYS:** For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So > These join two INDEPENDENT clauses with a comma: “I was tired, but I kept running.”

SLIDE 8 — Challenge 2 Questions

Text: > ## 🧵 Challenge 2: Compound Sentences with FANBOYS > > **Combine the sentences using the best coordinating conjunction. Choose the correct answer.** > > **1.** “I wanted pizza. The restaurant was closed.” > - A) I wanted pizza, and the restaurant was closed. > - B) I wanted pizza, but the restaurant was closed. ✅ > - C) I wanted pizza, so the restaurant was closed. > > **2.** “She practiced every day. She made the team.” > - A) She practiced every day, yet she made the team. > - B) She practiced every day, but she made the team. > - C) She practiced every day, so she made the team. ✅ > > **3.** “We could go to the movies. We could stay home and play games.” > - A) We could go to the movies, or we could stay home and play games. ✅ > - B) We could go to the movies, so we could stay home and play games. > - C) We could go to the movies, for we could stay home and play games. > > **4.** “It was raining hard. We still went to the park.” > - A) It was raining hard, so we still went to the park. > - B) It was raining hard, yet we still went to the park. ✅ > - C) It was raining hard, and we still went to the park.

Correct Answers: 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-B

SLIDE 8B — Hint

Text: > ## 🦜 Polly’s Hint: > “SQUAWK! Think about the RELATIONSHIP between the two sentences! Contrast/surprise = BUT or YET. Cause/effect = SO. Choice = OR. Adding info = AND. Read each option aloud — which one MAKES SENSE?”

SLIDE 9 — Challenge 2 Reward

Text: > ##  Rope Earned!   >  “SQUAWK! You’re smarter than you look! Take the rope!” > #  Coordinate: **3** >  Record on your Raft Tracker!  *Challenge 3!*

CHALLENGE 3: The Sail Cave (Prepositional Phrases)

SLIDE 10 — Challenge 3 Story

Visual: A dim cave with a tattered sail hanging from the ceiling. A crab with glowing eyes guards it. Treasure scattered around.

Text: > ##  Challenge 3: The Sail Cave > > Clawdius the Crab guards the sail deep in a cave! > >  “I’ll trade you this sail for some grammar knowledge! Show me you can identify **prepositional phrases** — groups of words that start with a preposition and end with a noun!” > >  **Common Prepositions:** in, on, at, by, for, with, about, under, over, through, between, during, before, after > > **Prepositional Phrase = preposition + noun (object)** > “The cat slept **under the warm blanket.**”

SLIDE 11 — Challenge 3 Questions

Text: > ##  Challenge 3: Prepositional Phrases > > **Identify the prepositional phrase in each sentence.** > > **1.** The bird flew over the tall trees. > - A) The bird flew > - B) over the tall trees  > - C) flew over > > **2.** She left her backpack under the desk. > - A) She left her > - B) backpack under > - C) under the desk  > > **3.** During the storm, the power went out. > - A) During the storm  > - B) the power went > - C) went out > > **4.** The secret passage led through the old tunnel. > - A) The secret passage > - B) passage led through > - C) through the old tunnel  > > **5.** We ate lunch at the new restaurant by the lake. > - A) at the new restaurant  (also accept “by the lake”) > - B) We ate lunch > - C) the new restaurant

Correct Answers: 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-C, 5-A

SLIDE 11B — Hint

Text: > ##  Clawdius’s Hint: > “A prepositional phrase **STARTS** with a preposition (in, on, under, over, through, during, at, by...) and **ENDS** with a noun. It answers **WHERE**, **WHEN**, or **HOW**. Find the preposition first, then grab everything until the next noun!”

SLIDE 12 — Challenge 3 Reward

Text: > ##  Sail Earned!   >  “Not bad for a landlubber! Take the sail and this coordinate!” > #  Coordinate: 7 >  Record on your Raft Tracker!  *Challenge 4!*

CHALLENGE 4: The Map Mountain (Irregular Past Tense Verbs)

SLIDE 13 — Challenge 4 Story

Visual: A misty mountain peak with a treasure map pinned to a rock at the top.
Mountain goat character wearing glasses.

Text: > ##  Challenge 4: The Map Mountain > > Professor Goat has the map, but he’s a stickler for grammar! > >  “Irregular verbs! They DON’T follow the normal ‘-ed’ rule for past tense. You must KNOW them! Prove your knowledge and the map is yours!” > >

 **Regular:** walk → walked, play → played (just add -ed) > **Irregular:** go → went, run → ran, write → wrote (they CHANGE!)

SLIDE 14 — Challenge 4 Questions

Text: > ##  Challenge 4: Irregular Past Tense > > **Choose the correct PAST**

TENSE form of the verb. > > **1.** Yesterday, I ____ (drink) three glasses of water. > - A) drank > - B) drunk  > - C) drunk > > **2.** She ____ (bring) her favorite book to school. > - A) bringed > - B) brang > - C) brought  > > **3.** The bird ____ (fly) south for the winter. > - A) flyed > - B) flew  > - C) flown > > **4.** He ____ (teach) us a new song last week. > - A) teached > - B) taught > - C) taught  > > **5.** They ____ (swim) across the lake in record time. > - A) swam  > - B) swimmied > - C) swum

Correct Answers: 1-B, 2-C, 3-B, 4-C, 5-A

SLIDE 14B — Hint

Text: > ##  Professor Goat’s Hint: > “Irregular verbs are tricky because you can’t just add ‘-ed’! If an answer has ‘-ed’ added to an irregular verb (like ‘drinked’ or ‘bringed’), it’s

WRONG. These verbs change their spelling entirely. When in doubt, say it aloud — does it SOUND right?”

SLIDE 15 — Challenge 4 Reward

Text: > ##  Map Earned!   >  “Splendid verb work! Here’s your map and coordinate!” > #  Coordinate: **W** >  Record on your Raft Tracker!  *Final challenge!*

CHALLENGE 5: The Flag Fortress (Mixed Review — Complex Sentences)

SLIDE 16 — Challenge 5 Story

Visual: A stone fortress on the beach with a flag flying from the top. All the island animals gathered around it. Dramatic sunset.

Text: > ##  Challenge 5: The Flag Fortress > > The final piece — the flag — is locked inside the fortress! All the island animals watch as you face the ultimate challenge. > >  “This is it, survivor! This challenge mixes EVERYTHING — conjunctions, prepositional phrases, verb tenses, and complex sentences. Show us what you’ve got!”

SLIDE 17 — Challenge 5 Questions

Text: > ##  Challenge 5: The Ultimate Grammar Challenge > > **Choose the sentence that is written CORRECTLY.** > > **1.** > - A) Although she runned fast, she missed the bus. > - B) Although she ran fast, she missed the bus.  > - C) Although she ran fast she missed the bus. > > **2.** > - A) The book on the shelf was wrote by my favorite author. > - B) The book on the shelf was written by my favorite author.  > - C) The book in the shelf was written by my favorite author. > > **3.** > - A) Because the game was canceled we went to the mall. > - B) Because the game was canceled, we went to the mall.  > - C) The game was canceled, because we went to the mall. > > **4.** > - A) They have ate lunch, so they went outside to play. > - B) They had eaten lunch so they went outside to play. > - C) They had eaten lunch, so they went outside to play.  > > **5.** Which sentence uses a prepositional phrase AND a subordinating conjunction correctly? > - A) Before the

movie started, we bought popcorn at the counter.  > - B) Before the movie started we bought popcorn at the counter. > - C) Before the movie started, we buyed popcorn at the counter.

Correct Answers: 1-B, 2-B, 3-B, 4-C, 5-A

SLIDE 17B — Hint

Text: > ##  Island Animals' Combined Hint: >  "Check the verb tenses — are they irregular? Is the past tense correct?" >  "SQUAWK! Look for commas — does the sentence need one after the dependent clause?" >  "Prepositional phrases — does the preposition make SENSE? (on the shelf, not IN the shelf)" >  "Read the WHOLE sentence. Every part must work together!"

SLIDE 18 — Challenge 5 Reward

Text: > ##  Flag Earned!  > "ALL island animals cheer! You've earned the final piece!" > #  Coordinate: **2** >  Record on your Raft Tracker!

FINAL PUZZLE

SLIDE 19 — Chart Your Escape

Visual: The completed raft on the shore with all 5 pieces visible. A compass rose with coordinate slots. The ocean beckons.

Text: > ##  Chart Your Escape Route! > > Your raft is complete! Now enter the coordinates to set sail! > > | Piece | Coordinate | > |---|---| > |  Logs | N | > |  Rope | 3 | > |  Sail | 7 | > |  Map | W | > |  Flag | 2 | > > ##  Escape
Coordinates: **N-3-7-W-2** > > Type the coordinates to set sail! > >  *Click to ESCAPE!*

SLIDE 20 — ESCAPE!

Visual: The raft sailing away from the island into a gorgeous sunset. Dolphins jumping alongside. All island animals waving from shore. Fireworks in the sky.

Text: > ## 🎉🏝️ YOU ESCAPED GRAMMAR ISLAND! 🏝️🎉 > > 🌊🚤🌊 > >

CONGRATULATIONS, SURVIVOR! > > You built your raft, charted your course, and sailed to freedom! > > ✅ Subordinating Conjunctions — MASTERED > ✅ Coordinating Conjunctions — MASTERED > ✅ Prepositional Phrases — MASTERED > ✅ Irregular Past Tense — MASTERED > ✅ Complex Sentences — MASTERED > > *You are now an official Grammar Island Survivor!*

📌 SLIDE 21 — Certificate

Text: > ## 🏆 Certificate of Achievement > > **This certifies that** > > _____ > > **has survived GRAMMAR ISLAND** > **and is now a certified Grammar Island Survivor!** 🏝️ > > ★ Conjunctions ★ Prepositional Phrases ★ Verb Tenses ★ Complex Sentences > > Date: _____ | Captain Castaway's Signature: _____

TEACHER ANSWER KEY (Quick Reference)

Challenge	Q#	Correct Answer
1 (Lagoon)	1	B) After
1	2	A) until
1	3	B) Although
1	4	C) whenever
1	5	B) since
2 (Bridge)	1	B) but
2	2	C) so
2	3	A) or
2	4	B) yet
3 (Cave)	1	B) over the tall trees

Challenge	Q#	Correct Answer
3	2	C) under the desk
3	3	A) During the storm
3	4	C) through the old tunnel
3	5	A) at the new restaurant
4 (Mountain)	1	B) drank
4	2	C) brought
4	3	B) flew
4	4	C) taught
4	5	A) swam
5 (Fortress)	1	B) ran + comma
5	2	B) written + on
5	3	B) comma after canceled
5	4	C) eaten + comma
5	5	A) Before + comma + bought

Escape Coordinates: N-3-7-W-2



Grammar Island Survivor — Teacher Guide

Escape Room 3 | 5th Grade | 30–45 Minutes



Overview

Students are stranded on Grammar Island and must solve 5 grammar challenges to earn raft pieces and escape. Covers complex sentences, conjunctions, prepositional phrases, and irregular past tense verbs.

TEKS: 5.11D.vii (subordinating conjunctions), 5.11D.ii (past tense of irregular verbs)

How to Assign in Google Classroom

1. Classwork → + **Create** → **Assignment**
 2. Attach Google Slides → **“Make a copy for each student”**
 3. Instructions: *“You’re stranded on Grammar Island! Solve 5 grammar challenges to build your escape raft. Record your coordinates on the Raft Tracker (Slide 3).”*
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Timing

Setup	Activity	Wrap-Up
5 min	30–40 min	5 min

This escape room is slightly more challenging (5th grade) — allow full 45 minutes for struggling learners.

Differentiation

Struggling Learners:

- Provide a conjunction reference chart (FANBOYS + subordinating list)
- Allow partner work
- Pre-teach irregular verb forms with a quick sort activity
- Skip Challenge 5 (mixed review) if needed — award the coordinate freely

Advanced Learners:

- Write a “Survivor Journal” using all 4 grammar skills in a paragraph
- Create Challenge 6 with their own questions
- Identify MULTIPLE prepositional phrases per sentence in Challenge 3
- Time challenge: escape in under 20 minutes

ELL Students:

- Irregular verbs are especially challenging for ELLs — provide a past tense verb chart
 - Pre-teach prepositions with physical demonstrations (put the book ON, UNDER, BESIDE)
 - Allow use of bilingual resources
-



Center vs. Whole Class

Center:

- 1–2 rotation periods
- Pair struggling/advanced students strategically
- Provide printed conjunction/preposition reference at the center

Whole Class:

- Work through Challenge 1 together as a model
 - Release students for independent work on Challenges 2–5
 - Debrief Challenge 5 together (mixed review generates great discussion)
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Extension Activities

1. **Island Journal:** Write a 3-paragraph survival story using at least 5 subordinating conjunctions, 5 prepositional phrases, and 5 irregular past tense verbs
2. **Conjunction Sort:** Cut-and-sort activity separating coordinating from subordinating conjunctions
3. **Irregular Verb Memory Match:** Create cards matching present to past tense

4. **Prepositional Phrase Hunt:** Find 10 prepositional phrases in a chapter book

Assessment

- Strong formative assessment for 5th grade grammar conventions
- Excellent STAAR prep for grammar/editing questions
- Use Challenge 5 (mixed review) scores to identify which skills need reteaching



Grammar Island Survivor — Answer Key

Escape Room 3 | 5th Grade

Escape Coordinates: N-3-7-W-2



Challenge 1: Log Lagoon — Subordinating Conjunctions (Coordinate: N)

#	Sentence	Correct	Explanation
1	___ the sun went down, the temperature dropped.	After	Shows time sequence — one event after another.
2	We can't go swimming ___ the lifeguard arrives.	until	Condition that must be met before the action can happen.
3	___ she studied all night, she still felt nervous.	Although	Shows contrast — studying SHOULD help, but she's still nervous.
4	The dog hides under the bed ___ there is	whenever	Shows a repeated condition — every time there's thunder.

#	Sentence	Correct	Explanation
	thunder.		
5	You should wear a jacket _____ it is cold outside.	since	Shows reason/cause — because it's cold.

Common Mistakes: Choosing coordinating conjunctions (and, but, or) instead of subordinating ones. Remind students: subordinating conjunctions create DEPENDENT clauses that can't stand alone.



Challenge 2: Rope Bridge — FANBOYS / Compound Sentences (Coordinate: 3)

#	Sentences	Correct Conjunction	Explanation
1	Wanted pizza / restaurant closed	but	Contrast — you wanted something, but couldn't get it.
2	Practiced every day / made the team	so	Cause and effect — practicing LED TO making the team.
3	Go to movies / stay home	or	Choice between two options.
4	Raining hard / still went to park	yet	Contrast/surprise — despite rain, they went anyway.

Common Mistakes: Confusing “but” and “yet” — both show contrast, but “yet” implies more surprise. Confusing “so” (result) with “and” (addition).



Challenge 3: Sail Cave — Prepositional Phrases

(Coordinate: 7)

#	Sentence	Prep Phrase	Preposition
1	Bird flew over the tall trees	over the tall trees	over
2	Backpack under the desk	under the desk	under
3	During the storm, power went out	During the storm	During
4	Led through the old tunnel	through the old tunnel	through
5	Ate lunch at the new restaurant	at the new restaurant	at (also “by the lake”)

Common Mistakes: Including the verb in the phrase (“flew over” is NOT the prepositional phrase — just “over the tall trees”). Students also confuse prepositional phrases with the subject/verb of the sentence.



Challenge 4: Map Mountain — Irregular Past Tense

(Coordinate: W)

#	Verb	Correct Past Tense	Common Wrong Answer
1	drink	drank	“drinked” (adding -ed to irregular)
2	bring	brought	“bringed” or “brang”
3	fly	flew	“flyed”
4	teach	taught	“teached”

#	Verb	Correct Past Tense	Common Wrong Answer
5	swim	swam	“swimmed”

Common Mistakes: Adding “-ed” to irregular verbs is the #1 error. Also confusing simple past (drank, swam) with past participle (drunk, swum) — these are different! Simple past stands alone; past participle needs a helper (has/had/have).

Challenge 5: Flag Fortress — Mixed Review (Coordinate: 2)

#	Correct Answer	Why Others Are Wrong
1	B) “Although she ran fast, she missed the bus.”	A: “runned” isn’t a word. C: missing comma after dependent clause.
2	B) “The book on the shelf was written by my favorite author.”	A: “wrote” should be “written” with “was.” C: “in the shelf” — books go ON shelves.
3	B) “Because the game was canceled, we went to the mall.”	A: missing comma. C: reverses cause and effect.
4	C) “They had eaten lunch, so they went outside to play.”	A: “ate” should be “eaten” with “had.” B: missing comma before “so.”
5	A) “Before the movie started, we bought popcorn at the counter.”	B: missing comma. C: “buyed” — “buy” → “bought.”

Common Mistakes: Q2 is tricky because students must check BOTH the verb (“written” vs “wrote”) AND the preposition (“on” vs “in”). Multiple skills combined = harder.